

Facilitator guide — Prompting Techniques

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About these activities

Prompting Techniques builds the skill of **asking the AI well**. It moves from a single clear prompt, through exploration and comparing approaches, to refining and verifying — the foundation for every AI-assisted activity later in the workshop.

Six handouts. ~115 min of participant time.

How to run it

- Handout 1, **build a clear prompt**, is the foundation — don't skip it. Everything else assumes it.
- Most of these are platform activities: demo briefly, then participants follow the handout.
- Handout 4 is **solo** work; the rest suit pairs or teams.
- The mindset to instill: a good prompt is rarely the first one written. Refining is the skill, not a failure.

The activities

1. Build a clear prompt

Activity · ~15 min

What it is — a foundation activity: four questions to answer before writing any prompt.

What the handout covers — a what / who / scope / success worksheet, then writing a prompt from those answers.

Watch for — participants want one perfect prompt. Stress that refining is normal — the four questions just produce a stronger *first* message.

2. Explore with the AI Assistant

Activity · ~20 min

What it is — a hands-on activity: test a prompt on the platform, vary one thing, ask a follow-up.

What the handout covers — a base prompt, a one-variable change, a follow-up question; save what's useful.

Watch for — participants change two things at once. One variable at a time — observe, then change the next.

3. Iterative vs single prompt

Activity · ~30 min

What it is — a comparison activity: build the same 3-slide report two ways.

What the handout covers — Exercise A (four iterative prompts), Exercise B (one structured prompt), a reflection, and a when-to-use-each table.

Watch for — participants treat one approach as "better". Both are valid — the point is to match the approach to the task.

4. Refine your prompt (solo)

Activity · ~20 min

What it is — a solo exercise tightening one prompt over three rounds.

What the handout covers — pick one topic, run three rounds (start simple, add context, make it actionable), each in a fresh conversation, then reflect.

Watch for — participants don't notice *why* the last prompt worked. Push them to name what each round added — where/when, then why/who.

5. Use a previous report as a template

Activity · ~10 min

What it is — a hands-on activity guiding the AI from an example you already trust.

What the handout covers — upload a previous report to Resources, include it in the AI conversation, ask the AI to reproduce the structure.

Watch for — even with a template the AI can drift. Participants must compare the output side-by-side with the model before sharing.

6. Verify the AI's output

Activity · ~20 min

What it is — a hands-on verification activity: a repeatable check before delivering AI-generated text.

What the handout covers — read and mark claims, triage by risk, hand-check high-risk claims, AI-check medium-risk, a final consistency scan.

Watch for — participants rush this; it needs the full 20 minutes. The rule to leave them with: *if you wouldn't sign it, it isn't finished.*

Wrapping up

Verification (Activity 6) is the note to end on. Prompting well gets a fast draft; verifying well is what makes it the participant's own work.